

WRITTEN BY @RUIDO.98

Midjourney Basic Guide

INTRODUCTION

KEYWORDS

DISCORD

Quick-start guide to Midjourney: basic commands,
prompt structure, and tips to get better results.
Perfect for beginners or anyone looking to refine
their creative workflow.

WRITTEN BY
@RUIDO.98

Midjourney Basic Guide

This is a guide to help you learn how to use Midjourney. It was written by me, Jesús Llancare (Ruido98), and curated based on the knowledge I've gathered through my own experience.

This guide is free, so please don't sell or redistribute it.

If you mention it on social media, make sure to give credit and tag me — I'd love to repost it on my Instagram stories too.

R98



Presentation

Thank you so much for downloading this content — it was created by me, Jesús Llancare (a.k.a. Ruido98).

In case you don't know me yet, I'm a graphic designer and content creator. I don't consider myself an expert, but I know I love to constantly explore. That mindset — of learning and iterating — has helped me achieve the kind of visual results I share online.

I hope you enjoy this guide, built from my own experience using Midjourney.

Wishing you the best in your creative explorations — and I truly hope we can grow together, both professionally and creatively ✨



Imagen generada con la versión 7 de Midjourney



Introduction

To begin, I'd like to address the first dilemma many of us faced with the rise of Artificial Intelligence.

My view on using AI is that — without a doubt — it's a powerful set of tools that can save us time and greatly support our work and creative processes as designers. But I firmly believe that there must always be a human behind the tool, guiding it for the best results.

When a creative person uses Midjourney to explore new visual concepts, the outcomes can be amazing. But that doesn't mean replacing people or teams — it means enhancing the quality of the results and allowing creative teams to evolve in their processes and structures.

I believe adaptation is part of life. Change will always be present in everything we do, and embracing it helps us grow as individuals.

R98

Disclaimer

The information I'm about to share with you can be found scattered across forums, social media, and various websites that talk about Midjourney.

My goal is to show you how I personally achieve the results I share online — and to organize everything in a clear and enjoyable way for you. This guide took me several days of iteration, testing content structures, and gathering key details I believe are important to pass on.

I hope you find it useful! If you have any questions, feel free to contact me at: info@ruido98.com.

info@ruido98.com



[Cap. 1]

What is Midjourney?

Let's keep it simple: as you probably know, Midjourney helps you generate images from a prompt.

It was first launched in 2022, and ever since, there have been controversies around AI-generated images winning art and photography awards.

Starting in 2023, the results produced by Midjourney began to look almost real — making it harder to tell whether an image was created by AI.

It's currently on version 7.0, and this guide is based on that version.

Here are some interesting facts about Midjourney:

- It was originally created by a team of just 11 people.
- You can now use it directly from their web platform — not just through Discord.
- There's a separate app called Niji-journey, which focuses more on anime-style results.
- Users actively help train and improve the Midjourney model.
- The /describe function works kind of like reverse-engineering an image.

By the way, just a reminder — to use Midjourney, you need to pay for a subscription, since the free tier is no longer available due to high user demand. The Basic Plan is a great place to start ✨

[Cap. 2]

What are prompts?

A prompt is a description of what you want Midjourney to create. It can be a single word or a detailed phrase that includes specific characteristics.

Tips:

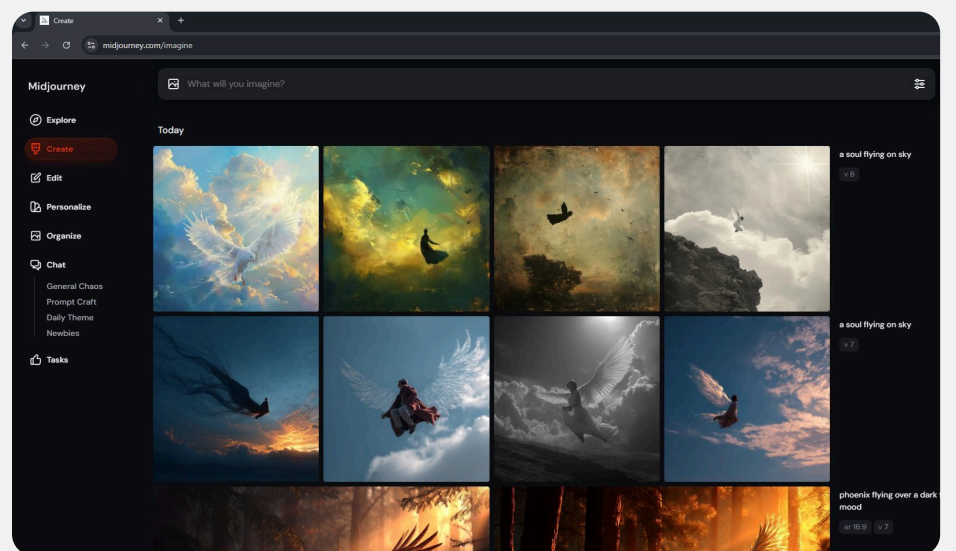
Be direct and write clearly what you want to see. Avoid being overly redundant with details, as the AI might misinterpret and generate something off.

Within a prompt, you can include:

- Subject: Who or what?
- Environment: Where?
- Lighting: What kind?
- Mood: What feeling or atmosphere should it convey?

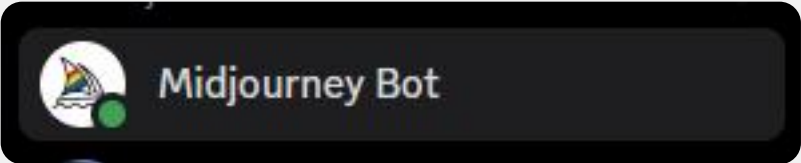
You can find more information about prompts on Midjourney's official site: <https://docs.midjourney.com/hc/en-us/articles/32023408776205-Prompt-Basics>

Para empezar a generar imágenes, si estás en la plataforma web de Midjourney basta con ir a la pestaña “Create” y empiezas a escribir en la entrada de texto que está en la parte superior. (justo donde dice “*What will you imagine*”)

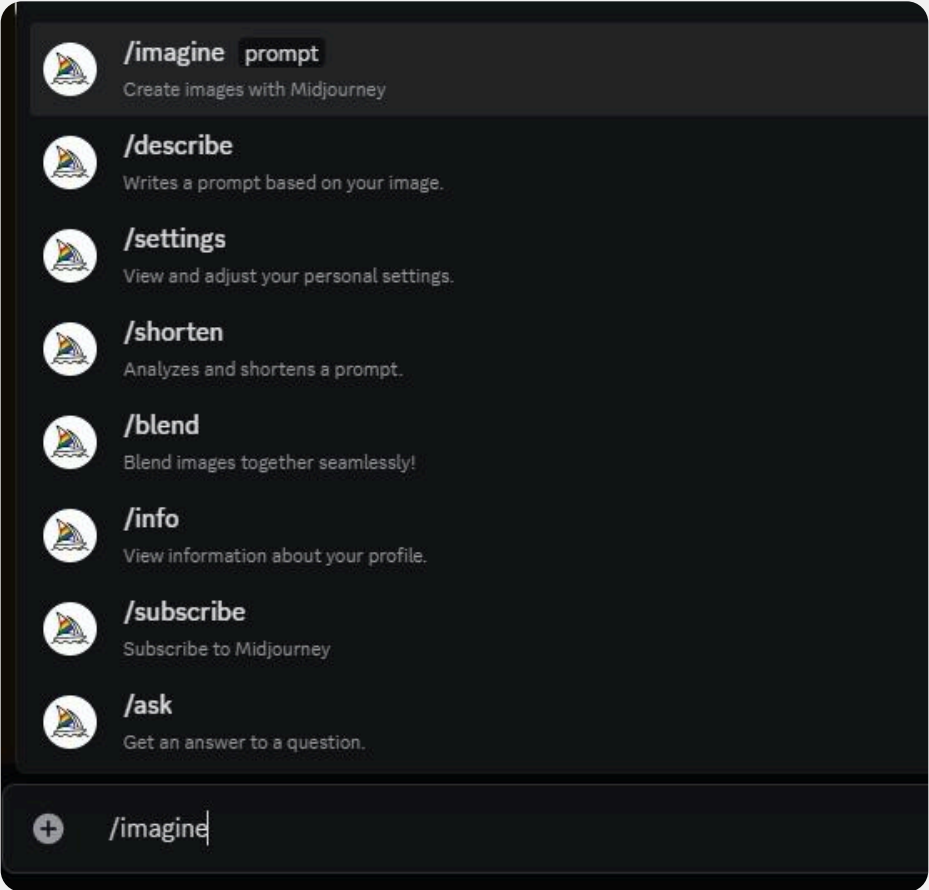


To start generating images, if you're using the Midjourney web platform, simply go to the “Create” tab and start typing in the text input at the top — right where it says “What will you imagine”.

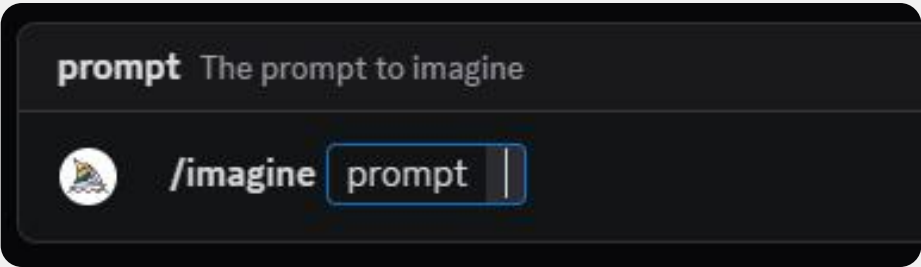
This is the bot:



You need to type “/imagine”.

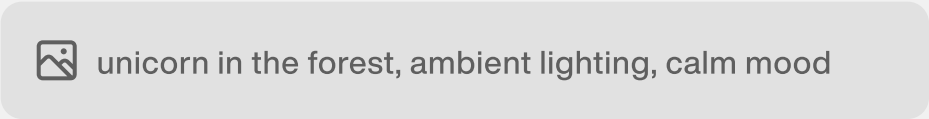


Hit enter and it should look like this:



Midjourney allows you to write prompts in Spanish, but I recommend using English since the words are more precise in the original language.

An example of a prompt using the elements mentioned earlier:



Subject:	Unicorn
Environment:	Forest
Lightning:	Ambient lightning
Mood:	Calm

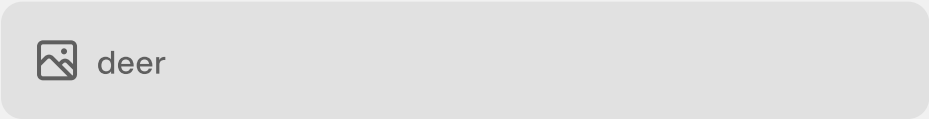
This is a basic prompt you can use to experiment with different combinations.

Using the example prompt, we can get results like these:

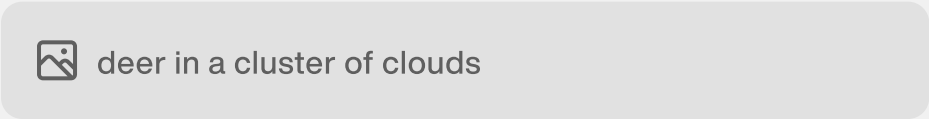


Let’s take it step by step:

Here’s another example — think of a character or animal you really like. For example, I really like deer.

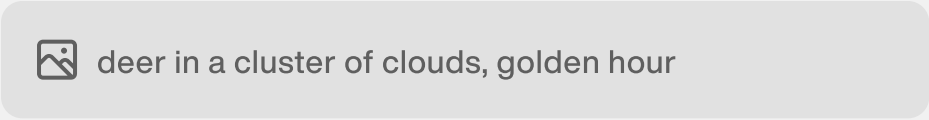


Now think of a place where you’d like to see that character. Don’t limit your imagination — we’re learning, and you can try anything you want. And if we make mistakes, even better — remember, the more we mess up, the more we learn. I’ll choose a cluster of clouds.



Next, let’s choose a type of lighting. You could write: soft light, golden hour, natural light, studio light, neon light, dramatic lighting, diffuse light, etc. This is constantly evolving thanks to the community that helps train the AI.

To add lighting to the prompt, just add a comma and then describe the type of lighting. This helps you build a better structure for your prompt and prioritize a sense of order while describing your scene.



Lastly, let’s add the mood. I personally love using “calm mood”, but you can try many others. I’ll share some lists later with terms you can use in your prompts.

 deer in a cluster of clouds, golden hour, calm mood

Now that we’ve built our first prompt, let’s press enter and see what results we get.

Midjourney always gives you 4 images to choose from. After that, you can continue iterating on the one you liked — or even modify it. Remember, you can generate your image either from Discord or directly on the Midjourney web platform.



Did you like the result Midjourney gave you?

In my case, yes — but I’m going to tweak the prompt a bit to get something closer to what I had in mind. First, I want it to be just one deer, and I also want it in close-up, with the cloud in the background and the lighting bringing the whole scene to life.

To specify quantity, I’ll simply add “a” before “deer”. But not just that — I’ll also use another term I really like: “close up”, which creates a tighter, more focused shot of the character in the final image.

Making those changes, the prompt would now look like this:

 close up of a deer in a cluster of clouds, golden hour, calm mood



I like these results much more.

I’ve always been drawn to ethereal and abstract concepts. Recently, someone asked me how I learned to design or create with that kind of aesthetic. Honestly, I’ve been interested in those concepts from the very beginning — so I think consistent practice, especially when focused on what feels natural to us, really helps us reach the style we’re aiming for.

In this chapter, we’ve learned how basic prompts work. There’s still a lot to discover, but this is a solid start.

Before moving on, I encourage you to take your time and experiment with variations of the prompt we’ve just explored. Try different characters, environments, lighting setups, and moods. Run a few tests — it’s the best way to get comfortable with Midjourney.

Here are a few examples:

 phoenix flying over a canyon, golden hour lighting, majestic mood

 cybernetic wolf in a neon-lit alley, neon lighting, tense mood

 robot child in a sunflower field, soft morning light, hopeful mood



ancient spirit near a frozen lake, overcast lighting,
melancholic mood



ancient spirit near a frozen lake, overcast lighting,
melancholic mood

Use your imagination to swap out each of the elements — and if you need help with that, here's a trick: use ChatGPT! Send it the base prompt and ask for variations of each part. ChatGPT is free, so it's a great tool to generate as many prompt ideas as you want.

Here's what I would send it:

[Give me 5 variations of this prompt: "unicorn in the forest, ambient lighting, calm mood". Changing the subject/character, the location, the type of lighting, and the mood.]

And if you want to share your first steps using MJ, please post them on Instagram — stories, feed, whatever works. I'd love to see your early creations 🙌🙌

You can tag me with the handle @ruido.98



[Cap. 3]

Keywords

These are terms that Midjourney uses as triggers to generate more accurate images.

To understand it better: they're words that activate specific visual details. Some very basic examples would be words like "natural", "golden hour", or "close up".

They may seem like common words, but within Midjourney's database, these terms carry much more visual information than they appear to. Some keywords can give you more precise results, others might be more generic, and others can lead to more interesting or stylized outcomes. Regardless of whether they're ambiguous or specific, Midjourney understands these words — and using the right ones helps you get better results.

Another great thing is that some of these keywords already include visual characteristics you don't need to describe in detail. So, using a good keyword can help you write shorter prompts.

Still not sure? Let me explain it with another example:



Sunny day, in the afternoon, with high-contrast lighting and orange tones

What I want to get with this prompt is a very aesthetic sunset. I've written down a few details I'd like to see in the image: I want the sun to be visible, but during the afternoon; I'd like high contrast in the lighting, and warm orange tones in the composition.

In this situation, I'm doing well by specifying the details I want — and I'll likely get good images that match those ideas.

But... what if I replaced all that description with a single word? Is there one term that includes all those visual elements?

Yes! The best keyword in this case would be: "golden hour."

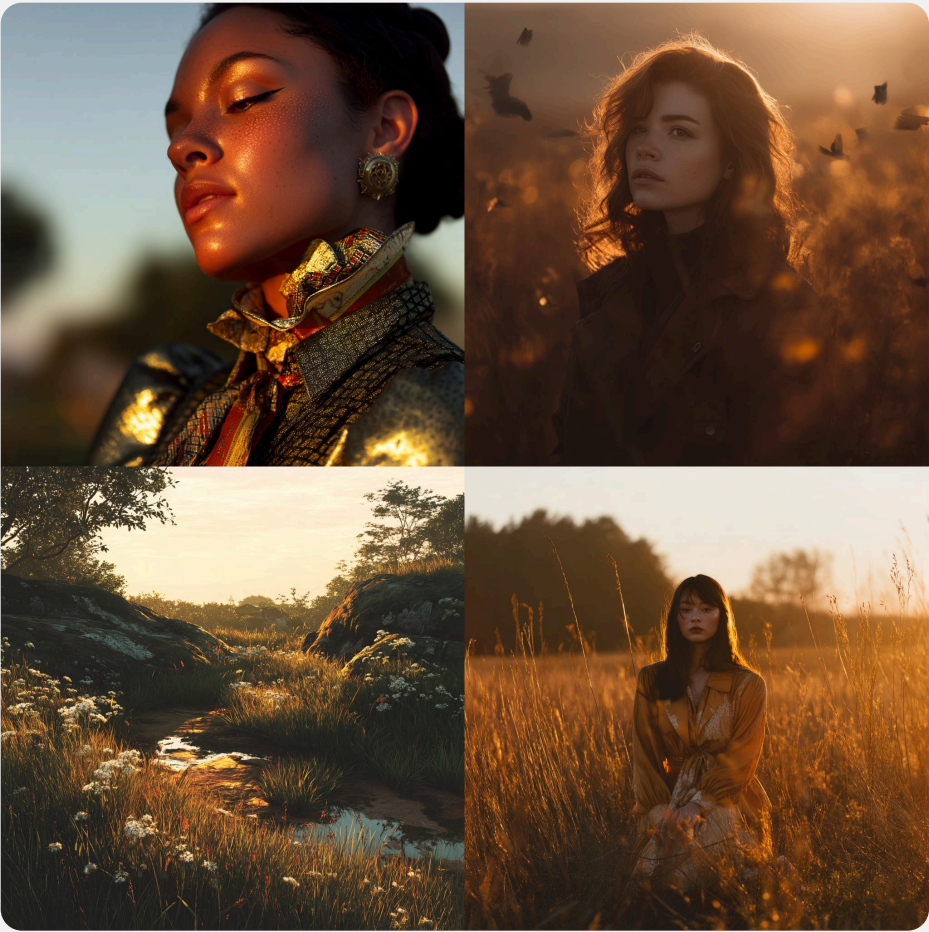
Let's compare the difference in results below:



This is the result of the prompt I wrote with detailed specifications. I really like the last image — I think it has the mood I was aiming for. However, in the first three results, I noticed different styles and varying situations across each scene.

Now let’s see what kind of result I get by changing the prompt and using the keyword “golden hour” instead.

 golden hour



I like this so much more! All the scenes match the aesthetic I was looking for. They also include the elements I described in the previous prompt — but the overall results are cleaner and more visually refined.

Now, I’ll show you a few lists of terms that tend to work really well with Midjourney — especially some of the keywords I personally use to generate the images I share online.

Illumination Keywords

Golden hour
Blue hour
Neon
Soft lighting
Studio lighting

Moods Keywords

Melancholic
Joyful
Mysterious
Romantic
Calm

Keywords for Artistic Styles

Gothic
Watercolor
Minimalist
Pop Art
Surrealist

These are some basic ones, but now I’ll share a few keywords I personally use to get more interesting results:

Interesting Keywords

Close up

This one helps me better capture the face of a character, since it frames the face nicely. You can also use it with objects — it brings the camera closer to the element, and in some cases, it focuses it against the background. You can also try other types of camera angles.

Portrait

It works similarly to the previous one, but this one is specifically for faces, and gives the results a more professional, portrait-style look. I highly recommend using it with specific characters, people, or animals.

Soul

This is my favorite keyword — I use it almost all the time. It’s one of the main reasons I’m able to get more ethereal and conceptual results. Use it wisely.

Peacefull

Great for calm scenes. I haven’t used it much, but I save it for special moments when I want to create artistic landscapes that evoke a sense of peace.

Optical Fibers

I found this term on Twitter. I’ve only used it a few times for more abstract images — and I think it works well when creating backgrounds for certain compositions. If you combine it with some --srefs, you can get really interesting results. (I’ll explain sref codes later.)

In this chapter, we learned about keywords and their importance in crafting prompts for Midjourney.

Just like in the previous chapter, I encourage you to explore and experiment with what you’ve learned before moving on. And don’t forget to share what you’re creating — tag me so I can see it too 🙌🙌

You can find even more keywords online — on certain websites or forums. I highly recommend checking out Twitter. Despite all the noise, there’s also a lot of valuable information being shared there.

If you visit Midjourney’s official Twitter account, they often repost work from other users — and some of those creators are great at sharing insights. You can learn a lot just by following those kinds of accounts.

Before we wrap up this chapter, I want to invite you to check out my second guide — there, I’ve included even more interesting keywords that I’ve tested myself and that have given me great results.

You can get it from my new shop: ruido98.gumroad.com



[Cap. 4]

Parameters

These are technical instructions added at the end of a prompt to tell Midjourney how it should generate an image.

Parameters go at the end of the prompt and are written with two dashes before the command.

For example: “--v 7” is a parameter that tells Midjourney to use version 7 when generating the image.

These parameters give us more control over the results.

They’re optional — you don’t need to use them — but as time goes on, you’ll probably want more specific outcomes depending on the purpose behind each image you create.

How many are there?

There are currently 23 parameters you can use.

Some of them are used often, while others are rarely necessary.

Here are a few of the most commonly used ones:

--ar	Aspect Ratio
--v	Version
--profile or --p	Personalization
--sref	Style Reference
--seed	Seed
--no	No
--weird	Weird

Aspect Ratio

```
--ar
```

Changes the aspect ratio of the image. For example, you can use: 16:9, 4:5, 1:1, 2:3, etc.

This also affects the final results, since the elements within a composition often follow the proportions of the canvas.

If you don't include this parameter, images will be generated by default in a 1:1 aspect ratio.

 phoenix flying over a dark forest, golden hour lighting, majestic mood



Let's try now with: --ar 16:9

 phoenix flying over a dark forest, golden hour lighting, majestic mood --ar 16:9



And now let's try: --ar 2:3

 phoenix flying over a dark forest, golden hour lighting, majestic mood --ar 2:3



Version

```
--v
```

This parameter tells Midjourney which version of the model to use. It has a major impact on the final image, since Midjourney is constantly evolving — and generally, the higher the version, the better the results.

You can also use older versions if you're aiming for a different aesthetic.

Personally, I sometimes go back to version 6.1 or 6.0, because that's when I first started learning about Midjourney, and there are certain looks I can get in those versions that I can't seem to recreate in version 7.

By default, Midjourney uses the latest version.

 a soul flying on sky --v 7.0



 a soul flying on sky --v 6.0



As you can see, there's a significant difference in the results Midjourney generates depending on which version is used.

This is one of the parameters I always use, since I like to specify the version I'm working with.

I also try to stay up to date with Midjourney's updates, so I can switch to newer versions when they become available.

Personalization

--p

This parameter activates a custom style profile that's been previously created in Midjourney. This profile is trained based on certain aesthetic preferences. You can create your own custom code, or you can also use codes created by other users. We'll dive deeper into this in the second guide, which is available in my store.

For now, I'll share my first custom code with you so I can show you a few examples — and so you can try it out in your own visual explorations.

 a woman portrait --ar 4:5



Here's the result of a prompt without using a custom style code.

As you can see, the results are generic. They're not bad — the image still has solid detail — but the aesthetics are very general.

Just adding a single custom code into your prompt can significantly impact the results, because these codes carry a specific visual direction that's been built by a user with their own aesthetic criteria.

Now let's use the same prompt, but add this code: gu23rmv. This is my first custom code — it's not fully developed the way I'd like yet, but I use it from time to time to get faces that don't look too generic.

 a woman portrait --ar 4:5 --p gu23rmv



Look closely at the features of the entire composition in each result. Compare the outcomes from the prompt without a custom code to these newer results.

Observe the facial features, the shape of the faces, and their defining characteristics. Also take note of the lighting and the environments where the character is placed.

These codes are unique and special.

You can find more online — some are made for highly specific artistic styles, while others are more general, based on each user's preferences.

Just a reminder: in the second Midjourney guide, I'll be sharing more codes with unique styles.

In this chapter, we've seen how parameters work and when we can use them.

More information about parameters here: <https://docs.midjourney.com/hc/en-us/articles/32859204029709-Parameter-List>

The next chapter will be the last in this guide — so I invite you to keep experimenting with what you've learned before moving on to the final part.

There are more and more possibilities of what we can create in Midjourney.

Remember to share your iterations with the world 🙌🙌

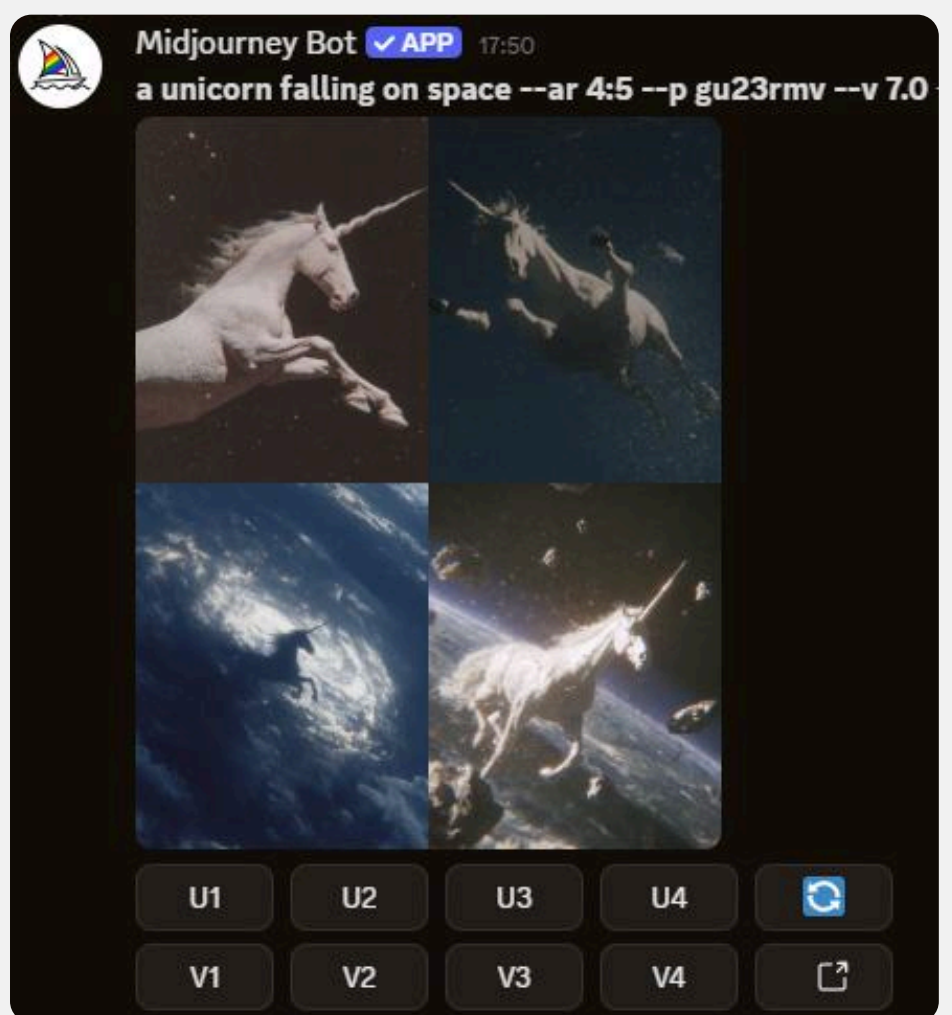
[Cap. 5]

Discord

Here I'll share some best practices you can apply when iterating in Midjourney.

These actions can be used directly from the Midjourney chatbot in Discord.

Discord Interface



When we generate an image, we see a set of buttons below it.

The first buttons, labeled with a “U” followed by a number, are used to upscale the image to its original size.

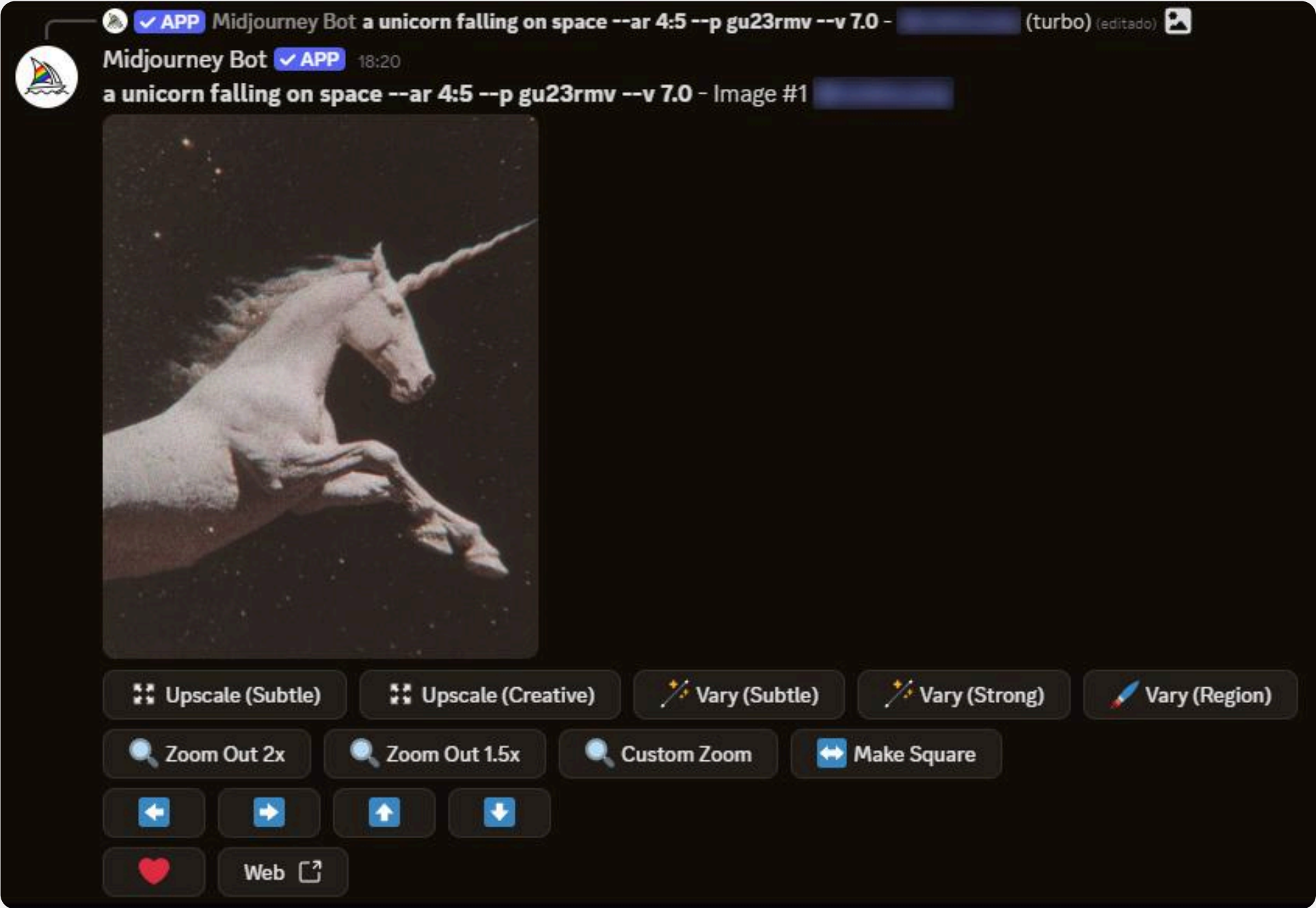
The numbers correspond to the position of each image in the grid.

The buttons labeled with a “V” are for requesting variations of that specific image.

The button with the  icon generates a new set of results using the same prompt.

And the last button redirects you to the Midjourney web platform.

Let’s try the first “U” button:



In general, the interface is very intuitive and easy to use. To download the image, you can click on it — this will open a preview of the generated image, and at the top you’ll see additional buttons, including the download button.

The rest of the buttons shown in the previous image do exactly what their names suggest.

Upscale buttons make the image larger and improve its resolution.

Vary buttons are used to generate variations of the selected image.

Zoom Out shows more of the composition around the canvas — in other words, it reduces the size of the current subject and generates new image content around it, as if it’s auto-completing the scene around the unicorn.

The arrows indicate which direction you want to extend or fill the image.

The heart icon should be used only when you truly like the result — it helps Midjourney improve and generate better outputs in future versions.

Another important detail in this interface is that it shows the prompt used to generate the image.

It also displays the generation speed — like “(Turbo)” — which can vary depending on the subscription plan you’re using.

Another way to download the image is by right-clicking on it and selecting “Save image”. You can do this either from the chat or from the interface that appears when you open the image.

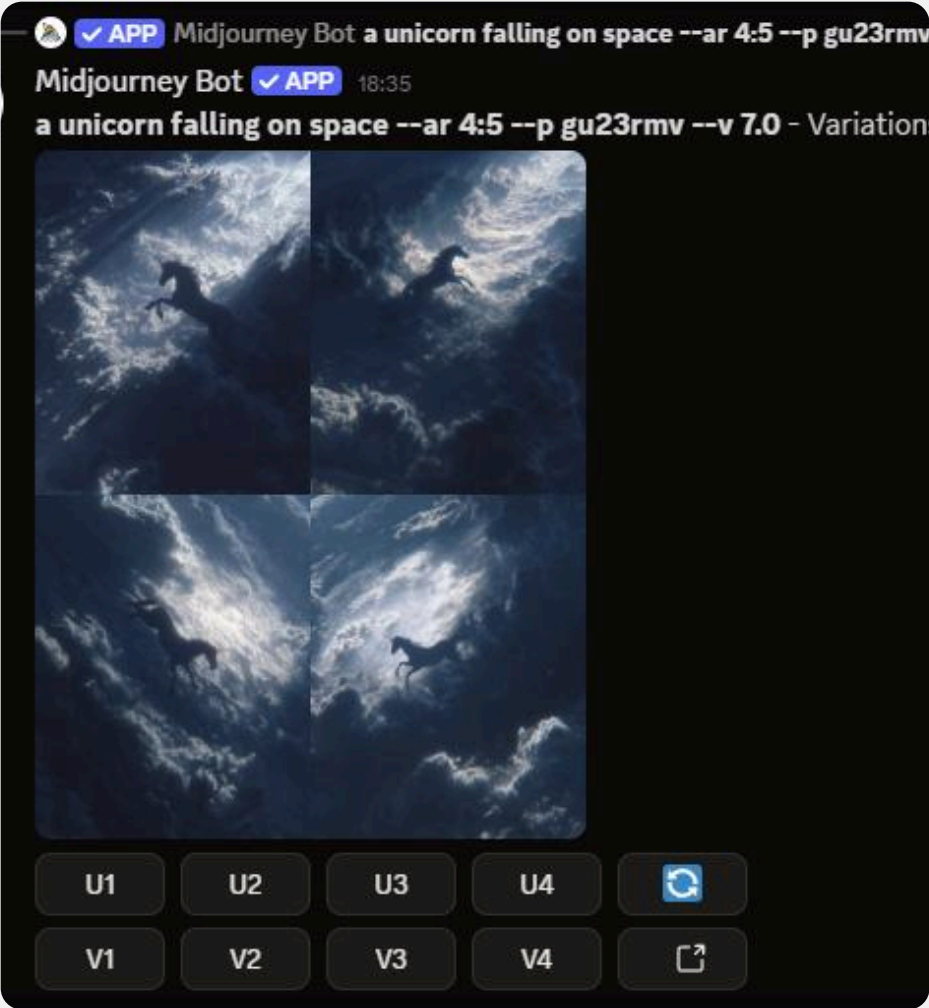
Midjourney-generated image sizes can’t be freely customized — there are certain limitations to the exact dimensions. The most you can do is upscale using the Upscale buttons, but that’s the limit.

If you try to upscale further beyond that point, you’ll only distort the image.

Now let’s see what happens when we click the buttons with the letter “V” to generate variations.

By the way, you can also click on another option while the current one is still loading. The speed of these results depends heavily on the type of subscription you have.

Let’s try “V” button:

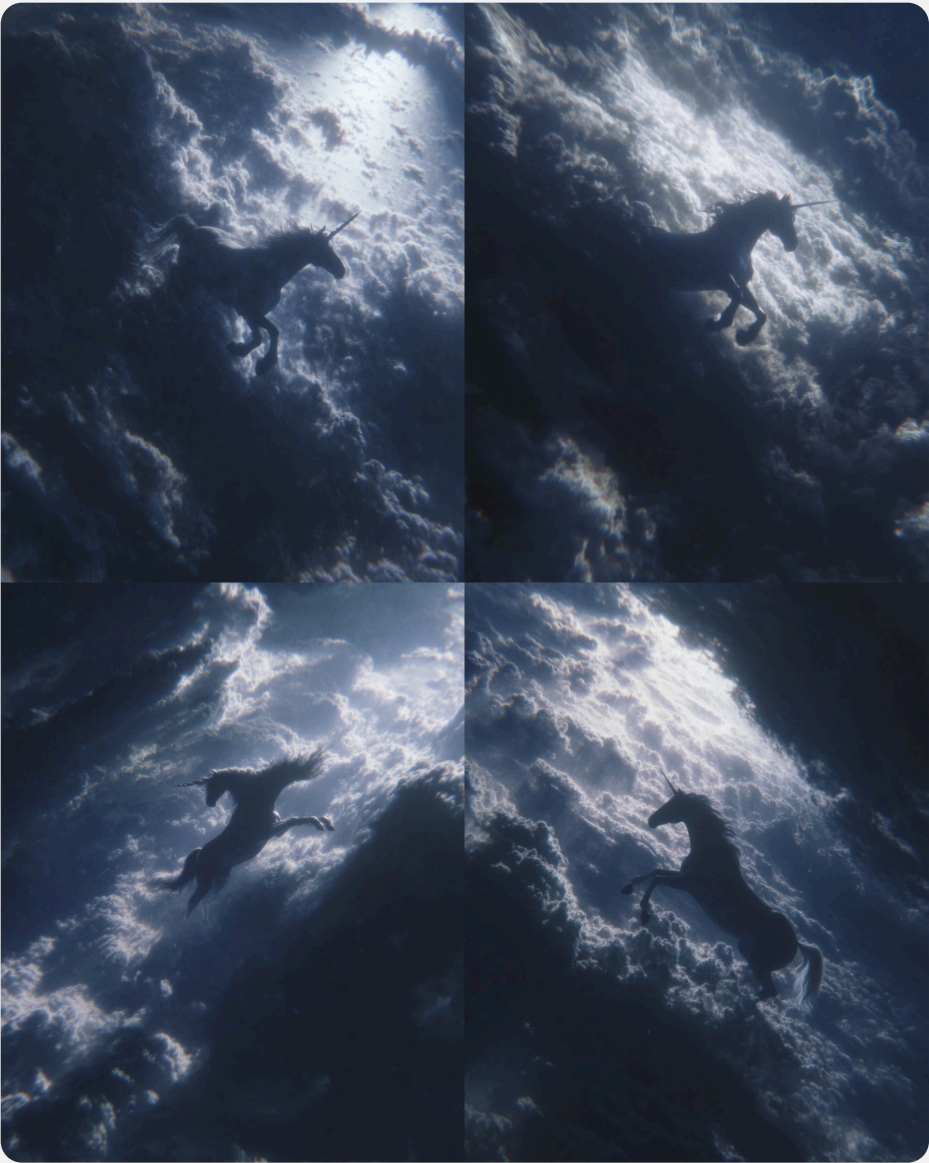


From this point on, we can keep generating new variations as many times as we want.

We can also adjust the intensity of these variations. There are two options, and you’ll see them by clicking one of the buttons that starts with “U”.

These options are “Vary (Subtle)” and “Vary (Strong)”. Let’s try it with the first image from our latest iteration.

These variations were generated using the “Strong” option:



And these were generated using the “Subtle” variation:



Let’s analyze the differences:

With Strong: The unicorn’s orientation changed — some are facing right, others left. One of them even has the head pointing one way and the body the opposite. Also, one of the images has noticeably different lighting compared to the others.

With Subtle: All the unicorns are facing the same direction and share similar lighting. Even the clouds look almost identical.

In this chapter, we learned how to use the Discord interface to optimize our workflow when generating images with Midjourney.

Never stop learning and exploring. Feel free to share your experiments on Instagram and tag me — @ruido.98 — I’d love to see what you create!

In the next guide, we’ll dive deeper into other Midjourney features, as well as more parameters and keywords to elevate your creative results.

Wishing you lots of success in everything you do! 🚀

Thank you again for downloading this guide.

Please do not sell or redistribute it.

I hope all this information has been helpful to you.

If you have any questions, feel free to contact me at:
info@ruido98.com

info@ruido98.com



I have a gift for you.

You can use this discount code to purchase
the next guide from my store:
ruido98.gumroad.com

The code is:

15OFFMJ

@Ruido.98

Midjourney Basic Guide

WRITTEN BY
@RUIDO.98

R98